



MPI

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📁 Class	High Performance Computing

- Message Passing Interface
- standard for distributed communication
- Basic outline:

```
# include <mpi.h>

int main(int argc, char* argv[]) {

    /* No MPI calls before this */
    MPI_Init(&argc, &argv);
    ...
    MPI_Finalize();
    /* No MPI calls after this */

    return 0;
```

Communicators

- sets of processes that can send messages to each other
- MPI_Init defines a communicator that consists of all the processes created when the program is started

- Called MPI_COMM_WORLD
- `MPI_Comm_size` gives the number of processes in the communicator
- `MPI_Comm_rank` gives the process number making the call

SPMD

- single program multiple data
- compile one program, each process does something different
- the if-else construct makes our program SPMD
- send and receive functions
- receiver waits for sender, matching tags
- communicator has to be the same

`MPI_STATUS* status;`

can tell you MPI_Source, MPI_TAG, and MPI_ERROR

MPI Collectives

Issues with send and receive:

- exact behavior is determined by the MPI implementation
- MPI_Send may behave differently with regard to buffer size, cutoffs, and blocking
- MPI_Recv always blocks until a matching message is received

Managing Input of MPI Programs

- most MPI implementations only allow process 0 in MPI_COMM_WORLD access to stdin
- process 0 must read the data (scanf) and sent to the other processes
- all the process in the communicator must call the same collective function
- a program that attempts to match a call to MPI_Reduce on one processes with a call o MPI_Recv on another process s erroneous, and in all likelihood, the program will hang or crash
- output_data_p argument is only used on dest_process
- all the process need to pass in an argument corresponding to output_data_p, even if its NULL
- point to point communications are matched on the basis of tags and communicators
- collective communications don't use tags
- they're matched solely on the basis of the communicator and the order in which they're called

MPI_Allreduce

- useful in a situate in which all of the processes need the result of a global sum in order to complete some larger computation
-

MPI_Scatterv

```
int MPI_Scatterv(void *sendbuf, int *sendcounts, int *displs,  
MPI_Datatype sendtype, void *recvbuf, int recvcount,  
MPI_Datatype recvtype, int root, MPI_Comm comm)
```

- sendbuf: Address of send buffer (choice, significant only at root).
- sendcounts: Integer array (of length group size) specifying the number of elements to send to each processor.
- displs: Integer array (of length group size). Entry i specifies the displacement (relative to sendbuf) from which to take the outgoing data to process i.
- sendtype: Datatype of send buffer elements (handle).
- recvcount: Number of elements in receive buffer (integer).
- recvtype: Datatype of receive buffer elements (handle).
- root: Rank of sending process (integer).
- comm: Communicator (handle).
- recvbuf: receiving buffer

- Gather: collect all of the components of the vector process on 0 and then 0 can use the vector, opposite of scatter
- Derived Datatypes:
 - Used to represent any collection of data items in memory by storing both the types of the items and their relative locations in memory
 - the idea is that if a function that sends data knows this information about a collection of data items, it can collect the items from memory before they are sent
 - similarly, a function that receives data can distribute the items into their correct destinations in memory when they're received
 - consists of a sequence of basic MPI data types together with a displacement for each of the data types

MPI_Type create_struct - builds a derived datatype that consists of individual elements that have different basic types

MPI_Get_address - returns the address of the memory location referenced by location_p

- the special type MPI_Aint is an integer that is big enough to store an address on the system

MPI_Wtime returns the number of seconds that have elapsed since some time in the past

MPI_Barrier - ensures that no process will return from calling it until every process in the communicator has started calling it

Safety in MPI Programs:

- The mpi standard allows MPI_Send to behave in two different ways
 - it can copy the message into an MPI managed buffer and return - async
 - or it can block until the matching call to MPI_Recv starts
 - many implementations of MPI set a threshold at which the system switches from buffering to blocking
 - relatively small messages will be buffered by MPI_Send
 - Larger messages will cause it to block
 - if the MPI_Send executed by each process blocks, no process will be able to start executing a call to MPI_Recv, and the program will hang or deadlock
 - each process is blocked waiting for an event that will never happen
- MPI Sendrecv
 - an alternative to scheduling the communications ourselves, carries out a blocking send and a receive in a single call
 - the dest and the source can be the same or different

- especially useful because MPI schedules the communications so that the program won't hang or crash
- point to point communications
- MPI_Ssend
 - synchronous send
 - guaranteed to block

For irregular connections:

- it is hard to figure out send receive sequence that does not deadlock or serialize
- even if you, you may have process idle time
- instead:
 - declare this data needs to be sent, these messages are expected and wait for them collectively

Non-Blocking send/recv

- start non-blocking communication MPI_Isend, MPI_Irecv
- wait for Isend/Irecv calls to finish in any order: MPI_Wait();

Latency Hiding

- other motivation for non-blocking calls:
- overlap of computation and communications, provided hardware support
- known as latency hiding
- example:
 - start communication for edge points
 - do local operations while communication goes on,

- wait for edge points from neighbor processes to incorporate incoming data

Parallel I/O

- multiple processes read from one file: no problem
- multiple writes to one file: big problem
- everyone writes to separate file: stress on the file system, and requires post-processing
- MPI_File_open is a collective call to open a file
 - collective is defined on the communicator
 - typically use MPI_COMM_WORLD as communicator
 - to open a file just on one process use MPI_COMM_SELF as the communicator
- all processes must call MPI_FILE_OPEN with the same filename and amode parameters
- file handle fh is then used in all subsequent file operations
- amode defines access mode for the file, there are multiple, and they can be combined
- MPI_File_close is a collective call to close a file
- all outstanding operations are synced on the file before it is closed

Displacements, elementary datatypes and offsets

- the displacement of a position within a file is the number of bytes from the beginning of the file

- etype ,or elementary datatype, is an MPI datatype
- an offset is a position in the file given in terms of multiples of etypes
- View, of the file is more natural, defined in terms of a displacement into the file and an etype, filetype, and data representation

MPI Examples

`MPI_Init` , `MPI_Comm_size` , `MPI_Comm_rank` , `MPI_Finalize`

```
#include <mpi.h>
#include <stdio.h>

int main(int argc, char** argv) {
    // Initialize the MPI execution environment.
    // This should be the very first MPI function called in any MPI program.
    MPI_Init(&argc, &argv);

    // Get the number of processes (also called ranks) in the communicator MPI_C
    // MPI_COMM_WORLD is the default communicator that includes all the proces
    int world_size;
    MPI_Comm_size(MPI_COMM_WORLD, &world_size);

    // Get the rank (unique identifier) of the calling process in the communicator.
    // Ranks are numbered from 0 to world_size - 1.
    int world_rank;
    MPI_Comm_rank(MPI_COMM_WORLD, &world_rank);

    // Now that we know our rank and the number of processes, we can print a sin
    printf("Hello world from process %d of %d\n", world_rank, world_size);

    // Finalize the MPI environment.
```



```

// This function cleans up the MPI environment and must be the last MPI call.
MPI_Finalize();

return 0;
}

```

`MPI_Send` , `MPI_Recv`

```

#include <mpi.h>
#include <stdio.h>
#include <string.h>

int main(int argc, char** argv) {
    // Initialize MPI environment.
    MPI_Init(&argc, &argv);

    // Get the rank and size within MPI_COMM_WORLD.
    int world_rank, world_size;
    MPI_Comm_rank(MPI_COMM_WORLD, &world_rank);
    MPI_Comm_size(MPI_COMM_WORLD, &world_size);

    // We require exactly 2 processes for this example.
    if (world_size != 2) {
        if (world_rank == 0) {
            fprintf(stderr, "World size must be exactly two for this example\n");
        }
        MPI_Finalize();
        return 1;
    }

    // Define the message buffer.
    char message[20];
}

```

```

if (world_rank == 0) {
    // Rank 0 prepares the message.
    strcpy(message, "Hello World");

    // Send the message to rank 1.
    // Parameters: buffer, count, datatype, destination rank, tag, communicator.
    MPI_Send(message, strlen(message) + 1, MPI_CHAR, 1, 0, MPI_COMM_WORLD);
    printf("Process 0 sent message: '%s'\n", message);
}
else if (world_rank == 1) {
    // Rank 1 receives the message from rank 0.
    // Parameters: buffer, count, datatype, source rank, tag, communicator, status.
    MPI_Recv(message, 20, MPI_CHAR, 0, 0, MPI_COMM_WORLD, MPI_STATUS_IGNORE);
    printf("Process 1 received message: '%s'\n", message);
}

// Finalize the MPI environment.
MPI_Finalize();

return 0;
}

```

Multiple Tags in Send & Recv

```

// Process 0
MPI_Send(int_data, num_elements, MPI_INT, 1, 0, MPI_COMM_WORLD); // Tag = 0
MPI_Send(str_data, strlen(str_data) + 1, MPI_CHAR, 1, 1, MPI_COMM_WORLD); // Tag = 1

// Process 1
MPI_Recv(int_data, num_elements, MPI_INT, 0, 0, MPI_COMM_WORLD, MPI_STATUS_IGNORE);
MPI_Recv(str_data, buffer_size, MPI_CHAR, 0, 1, MPI_COMM_WORLD, MPI_STATUS_IGNORE);

```

MPI_Reduce

```

#include <mpi.h>
#include <stdio.h>

int main(int argc, char** argv) {
    // 1) Initialize the MPI execution environment.
    // Must be called before any other MPI function.
    MPI_Init(&argc, &argv);

    // 2) Query the total number of processes in MPI_COMM_WORLD.
    int world_size;
    MPI_Comm_size(MPI_COMM_WORLD, &world_size);

    // 3) Query the rank (ID) of this process within MPI_COMM_WORLD.
    int world_rank;
    MPI_Comm_rank(MPI_COMM_WORLD, &world_rank);

    // Each process prepares a value to contribute: here, its own rank.
    int local_value = world_rank;

    // This will hold the result of the reduction on the root process.
    int global_sum = 0;

    // 4) Perform the reduction across all processes.
    // - sendbuf: address of local data      (&local_value)
    // - recvbuf: address for result on root  (&global_sum)
    // - count:  number of elements per process (1)
    // - datatype: MPI_INT for C `int`
    // - op:      MPI_SUM to sum all local_values
    // - root:    rank of the process that gets the result (0)
    // - comm:    communicator (MPI_COMM_WORLD)
    MPI_Reduce(
        &local_value, // sendbuf
        &global_sum,  // recvbuf (only significant at root)
        1,             // count

```

```

    MPI_INT,    // datatype
    MPI_SUM,    // operation
    0,          // root rank
    MPI_COMM_WORLD // communicator
);

// 5) Only the root process (rank 0) sees the correct global_sum.
if (world_rank == 0) {
    printf("Hello from %d processes! Sum of ranks = %d\n",
           world_size, global_sum);
}

// 6) Clean up the MPI environment.
// No MPI functions may be called after this.
MPI_Finalize();

return 0;
}

```

MPI_Allreduce

```

#include <mpi.h>
#include <stdio.h>

int main(int argc, char** argv) {
    // 1) Initialize the MPI environment.
    // Must be called before any other MPI function.
    MPI_Init(&argc, &argv);

    // 2) Find out how many processes are participating.
    int world_size;
    MPI_Comm_size(MPI_COMM_WORLD, &world_size);

    // 3) Determine the rank (ID) of this process.

```

```

int world_rank;
MPI_Comm_rank(MPI_COMM_WORLD, &world_rank);

// 4) Each process sets its local value to its own rank.
int local_value = world_rank;

// 5) Prepare a variable to hold the reduced (summed) result.
// After MPI_Allreduce, every process will have this value.
int global_sum = 0;

// 6) Perform an "all-reduce" across all ranks.
// - sendbuf: address of this process's data      (&local_value)
// - recvbuf: address where result will be stored  (&global_sum)
// - count: number of elements to reduce          (1)
// - datatype: MPI_INT for C `int`
// - op: MPI_SUM to sum all local_value entries
// - comm: communicator (MPI_COMM_WORLD)
//
// Unlike MPI_Reduce, MPI_Allreduce does the reduction and then
// broadcasts the result back to *all* processes, so each rank
// ends up with the final sum.
MPI_Allreduce(
    &local_value, // sendbuf
    &global_sum,  // recvbuf
    1,            // count
    MPI_INT,      // datatype
    MPI_SUM,      // operation
    MPI_COMM_WORLD // communicator
);

// 7) Now *every* process can use the global sum.
// Let's print it from each rank.
printf("Process %d of %d: global sum of ranks = %d\n",
    world_rank, world_size, global_sum);

// 8) Finalize the MPI environment.

```

```

// No MPI calls are allowed after this.
MPI_Finalize();

return 0;
}

```

MPI_Bcast

```

#include <mpi.h>
#include <stdio.h>
#include <string.h>

int main(int argc, char** argv) {
    // 1) Initialize the MPI environment.
    // Must be called before any other MPI functions.
    MPI_Init(&argc, &argv);

    // 2) Determine the total number of processes in MPI_COMM_WORLD.
    int world_size;
    MPI_Comm_size(MPI_COMM_WORLD, &world_size);

    // 3) Determine the rank (ID) of this process.
    int world_rank;
    MPI_Comm_rank(MPI_COMM_WORLD, &world_rank);

    // 4) Prepare a buffer for the message.
    // Note: all processes must allocate the buffer, even if only root writes into it.
    char message[32];

    if (world_rank == 0) {
        // 5) Root process (rank 0) initializes the message.
        strncpy(message, "Hello from MPI_Bcast!", sizeof(message));
        // Ensure null-termination in case of overflow
    }
}

```

```

    message[sizeof(message)-1] = '\0';
}

// 6) Broadcast the message from root to all processes.
// - buffer: address of the data to broadcast (&message)
// - count: maximum number of elements (32 chars)
// - datatype: MPI_CHAR (each element is a char)
// - root: rank of broadcaster (0)
// - comm: communicator (MPI_COMM_WORLD)
//
// After this call, 'message' on every rank contains the root's string.
MPI_Bcast(
    message,    // buffer
    32,        // count
    MPI_CHAR,   // datatype
    0,         // root rank
    MPI_COMM_WORLD // communicator
);

// 7) All processes can now safely use 'message'.
printf("Process %d/%d received message: '%s'\n",
    world_rank, world_size, message);

// 8) Finalize the MPI environment.
// No MPI calls may follow this.
MPI_Finalize();

return 0;
}

```

MPI_Scatter

```

#include <mpi.h>
#include <stdio.h>
#include <stdlib.h>

int main(int argc, char** argv) {
    // 1) Initialize the MPI environment.
    MPI_Init(&argc, &argv);

    // 2) Determine total number of processes.
    int world_size;
    MPI_Comm_size(MPI_COMM_WORLD, &world_size);

    // 3) Determine the rank (ID) of this process.
    int world_rank;
    MPI_Comm_rank(MPI_COMM_WORLD, &world_rank);

    // 4) Define how many elements each process should receive.
    // For this example, we'll give each process 2 integers.
    const int elems_per_proc = 2;

    // 5) Allocate space for each process's receive buffer.
    int* recv_buffer = malloc(sizeof(int) * elems_per_proc);

    // 6) On the root process (rank 0), prepare the full data array.
    int* send_buffer = NULL;
    if (world_rank == 0) {
        // Allocate and fill world_size * elems_per_proc values
        send_buffer = malloc(sizeof(int) * world_size * elems_per_proc);
        for (int i = 0; i < world_size * elems_per_proc; i++) {
            send_buffer[i] = i; // e.g., [0,1,2,3,4,5,...]
        }
        printf("Root process prepared data:");
        for (int i = 0; i < world_size * elems_per_proc; i++) {
            printf(" %d", send_buffer[i]);
        }
    }
}

```



```

    printf("\n");
}

// 7) Scatter the data:
// - send_buffer: array on root holding all data (ignored on non-root)
// - elems_per_proc: number of ints each process receives
// - MPI_INT: datatype of each element
// - recv_buffer: where each process stores its chunk
// - elems_per_proc: same count for receiving
// - MPI_INT: datatype of receive buffer
// - root = 0: the process that holds send_buffer
// - MPI_COMM_WORLD: communicator
MPI_Scatter(
    send_buffer,      // sendbuf (root only)
    elems_per_proc,  // sendcount
    MPI_INT,          // sendtype
    recv_buffer,      // recvbuf (all ranks)
    elems_per_proc,  // recvcount
    MPI_INT,          // recvtype
    0,                // root rank
    MPI_COMM_WORLD    // communicator
);

// 8) Each process now prints what it received.
printf("Process %d received:", world_rank);
for (int i = 0; i < elems_per_proc; i++) {
    printf(" %d", recv_buffer[i]);
}
printf("\n");

// 9) Clean up root's send_buffer and all ranks' recv_buffer.
if (world_rank == 0) free(send_buffer);
free(recv_buffer);

// 10) Finalize the MPI environment.
MPI_Finalize();

```

```
    return 0;
}
```

MPI_Scatterv

```
#include <mpi.h>
#include <stdio.h>
#include <stdlib.h>

int main(int argc, char** argv) {
    // 1) Initialize the MPI environment.
    MPI_Init(&argc, &argv);

    // 2) Find out how many processes are participating.
    int world_size;
    MPI_Comm_size(MPI_COMM_WORLD, &world_size);

    // 3) Find out this process's rank.
    int world_rank;
    MPI_Comm_rank(MPI_COMM_WORLD, &world_rank);

    // 4) Decide, for demonstration, that process i should receive (i+1) integers.
    //    Total elements = 1 + 2 + ... + world_size = world_size*(world_size+1)/2
    int *sendcounts = NULL;
    int *displs     = NULL;
    int total_elems = world_size * (world_size + 1) / 2;

    // 5) Root (rank 0) allocates and initializes the full send buffer,
    //    plus the arrays describing counts & displacements.
    int *sendbuf = NULL;
    if (world_rank == 0) {
        sendbuf = malloc(sizeof(int) * total_elems);
        sendcounts = malloc(sizeof(int) * world_size);
        displs     = malloc(sizeof(int) * world_size);
    }
```

```

// Fill sendcounts: process i gets (i+1) elements
for (int i = 0; i < world_size; i++) {
    sendcounts[i] = i + 1;
}

// Compute displacements: start of each block in sendbuf
displs[0] = 0;
for (int i = 1; i < world_size; i++) {
    displs[i] = displs[i-1] + sendcounts[i-1];
}

// Initialize the big array with sequential values
for (int i = 0; i < total_elems; i++) {
    sendbuf[i] = i;
}

// (Optional) print what root is scattering
printf("Root will scatter array of %d elements:\n", total_elems);
for (int i = 0; i < total_elems; i++) {
    printf(" %d", sendbuf[i]);
}
printf("\nSendcounts:");
for (int i = 0; i < world_size; i++) {
    printf(" %d", sendcounts[i]);
}
printf("\nDispls:");
for (int i = 0; i < world_size; i++) {
    printf(" %d", displs[i]);
}
printf("\n\n");
}

// 6) Each process allocates a receive buffer sized to its intended count.
int recvcount;
// We need to inform non-root ranks of how many they'll receive.

```

```

// One simple way: broadcast sendcounts array first.
if (world_rank == 0) {
    recvcount = sendcounts[0]; // placeholder for consistency
}
// Ensure everyone knows sendcounts (so they know their recvcount)
if (world_rank == 0) {
    // Root broadcasts the entire sendcounts array
    MPI_Bcast(sendcounts, world_size, MPI_INT, 0, MPI_COMM_WORLD);
} else {
    sendcounts = malloc(sizeof(int) * world_size);
    MPI_Bcast(sendcounts, world_size, MPI_INT, 0, MPI_COMM_WORLD);
}
recvcount = sendcounts[world_rank];

int *recvbuf = malloc(sizeof(int) * recvcount);

// 7) Perform the variable-length scatter:
// - sendbuf: full array at root (ignored elsewhere)
// - sendcounts: elements sent to each rank
// - displs: offsets where each block begins in sendbuf
// - MPI_INT: datatype of sendbuf elements
// - recvbuf: local buffer for each process
// - recvcount: number of elements this process receives
// - MPI_INT: datatype for recvbuf
// - root = 0: the scattering process
// - MPI_COMM_WORLD: communicator
MPI_Scatterv(
    sendbuf, // send buffer (root only)
    sendcounts, // send counts per rank
    displs, // displacements per rank
    MPI_INT, // send datatype
    recvbuf, // receive buffer (all ranks)
    recvcount, // receive count
    MPI_INT, // receive datatype
    0, // root rank
    MPI_COMM_WORLD

```

```

);

// 8) Each process prints its received chunk.
printf("Process %d received %d elements:", world_rank, recvcount);
for (int i = 0; i < recvcount; i++) {
    printf(" %d", recvbuf[i]);
}
printf("\n");

// 9) Cleanup
free(recvbuf);
if (world_rank == 0) {
    free(sendbuf);
    free(sendcounts);
    free(displs);
} else {
    free(sendcounts);
}

// 10) Finalize MPI.
MPI_Finalize();
return 0;
}

```

MPI_Gather

```

#include <mpi.h>
#include <stdio.h>
#include <stdlib.h>

int main(int argc, char** argv) {
    // 1) Initialize MPI environment.

```

```

MPI_Init(&argc, &argv);

// 2) Determine total number of processes.
int world_size;
MPI_Comm_size(MPI_COMM_WORLD, &world_size);

// 3) Determine this process's rank.
int world_rank;
MPI_Comm_rank(MPI_COMM_WORLD, &world_rank);

// 4) Each process prepares its local value (here, just its rank).
int local_value = world_rank;

// 5) On the root, allocate a buffer large enough to hold every rank's data.
int *gathered = NULL;
if (world_rank == 0) {
    gathered = malloc(sizeof(int) * world_size);
}

// 6) Gather all local_values to the root process:
// - sendbuf: address of this process's data (&local_value)
// - sendcount: number of items sent by each process (1)
// - sendtype: MPI_INT
// - recvbuf: address where root collects data (gathered)
//           (ignored on non-root ranks)
// - recvcount: number of items root expects from each process (1)
// - recvtype: MPI_INT
// - root: 0
// - comm: MPI_COMM_WORLD
MPI_Gather(
    &local_value, // send buffer (each rank)
    1,            // send count
    MPI_INT,      // send datatype
    gathered,     // receive buffer (root only)
    1,            // receive count per rank
    MPI_INT,      // receive datatype
    MPI_COMM_WORLD
);

```

```

    0,          // root rank
    MPI_COMM_WORLD // communicator
);

// 7) Root prints the array of gathered ranks.
if (world_rank == 0) {
    printf("Root has gathered ranks:");
    for (int i = 0; i < world_size; i++) {
        printf(" %d", gathered[i]);
    }
    printf("\n");
    free(gathered);
}

// 8) Finalize the MPI environment.
MPI_Finalize();
return 0;
}

```

MPI_Allgather

```

#include <mpi.h>
#include <stdio.h>
#include <stdlib.h>

int main(int argc, char** argv) {
    // 1) Initialize the MPI environment.
    MPI_Init(&argc, &argv);

    // 2) Determine total number of processes in MPI_COMM_WORLD.
    int world_size;
    MPI_Comm_size(MPI_COMM_WORLD, &world_size);
}

```

```

// 3) Determine the rank (ID) of this process.
int world_rank;
MPI_Comm_rank(MPI_COMM_WORLD, &world_rank);

// 4) Each process prepares its local value.
// Here we simply use the rank as the value.
int local_value = world_rank;

// 5) Allocate a receive buffer on each process to hold
// data from all processes: world_size elements.
int *recvbuf = malloc(sizeof(int) * world_size);
if (recvbuf == NULL) {
    fprintf(stderr, "Process %d: failed to allocate recvbuf\n", world_rank);
    MPI_Abort(MPI_COMM_WORLD, 1);
}

// 6) Perform the all-gather:
// - sendbuf: address of this process's data (&local_value)
// - sendcount: number of items sent by this process (1)
// - sendtype: MPI_INT
// - recvbuf: array where each process stores the concatenated results
// - recvcount: number of items contributed by each process (1)
// - recvtype: MPI_INT
// - comm: MPI_COMM_WORLD
//
// After this call, recvbuf on every process contains:
// [ value_from_rank_0, value_from_rank_1, ..., value_from_rank_{N-1} ]
MPI_Allgather(
    &local_value, // send buffer
    1,            // send count
    MPI_INT,      // send datatype
    recvbuf,      // receive buffer
    1,            // receive count per process
    MPI_INT,      // receive datatype
    MPI_COMM_WORLD // communicator
);

```



```
// 7) Print the gathered array from each process's perspective.
printf("Process %d received array:", world_rank);
for (int i = 0; i < world_size; i++) {
    printf(" %d", recvbuf[i]);
}
printf("\n");

// 8) Clean up.
free(recvbuf);

// 9) Finalize the MPI environment.
MPI_Finalize();
return 0;
}
```